

Move Code out of the Figure and Table Environments

Yihui Xie

September 22, 2026

Sometimes we may not want the code to be shown inside a float, such as a figure or table environment. The hook function `knitr::hook_movecode()` was designed for this purpose; it serves a document hook to post-process the LaTeX results.

First we set up the document hook:

```
library(knitr)
knit_hooks$set(document = hook_movecode)
```

Now we test a figure. You will see there is only a plot in Figure 1; the code was moved out of the environment, and shown below right after this paragraph.

```
summary(cars)

##           speed           dist
##  Min.      : 4.0   Min.      :  2
## 1st Qu.:12.0   1st Qu.: 26
##  Median :15.0   Median : 36
##   Mean  :15.4   Mean   : 43
## 3rd Qu.:19.0   3rd Qu.: 56
##   Max.  :25.0   Max.    :120

par(mar = c(4, 4, 0.1, 0.1))
plot(cars)
```

Similarly, you can work with tables; see Table 1.

```
library(knitr)
kable(head(iris))
```

If you do not label the figures or tables, or they do not have captions, the hook function `hook_movecode()` will not touch them. You can also specify a marker `% knitr_do_not_move` so that this hook function will leave them as is; see Table 2.

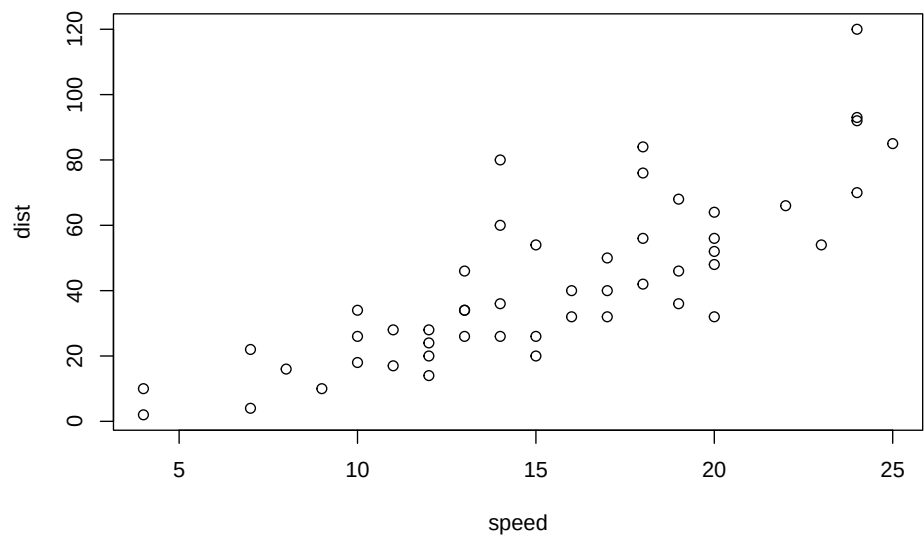


Figure 1: A figure caption here, and you must label it!

Table 1: A table caption here; again, you must label it.

Sepal.Length	Sepal.Width	Petal.Length	Petal.Width	Species
5.1	3.5	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.9	3.0	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.7	3.2	1.3	0.2	setosa
4.6	3.1	1.5	0.2	setosa
5.0	3.6	1.4	0.2	setosa
5.4	3.9	1.7	0.4	setosa

Table 2: This table environment must contain code.

```
library(knitr)
kable(head(iris))
```

Sepal.Length	Sepal.Width	Petal.Length	Petal.Width	Species
5.1	3.5	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.9	3.0	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.7	3.2	1.3	0.2	setosa
4.6	3.1	1.5	0.2	setosa
5.0	3.6	1.4	0.2	setosa
5.4	3.9	1.7	0.4	setosa

Although **knitr** supports figure captions and labels through the chunk options like `fig.cap`, sometimes it can be preferable to explicitly write these environments. For example, you do not have to write a really long figure caption in the chunk header in one line.

This hook function can also be particularly useful in LyX.